

Unit-4

INTERVIEW PROCESS

MEANING OF INTERVIEW

An interview is a formal or informal conversation between an interviewer (or a panel of interviewers) and an interviewee, typically conducted to assess the qualifications, skills, experience, and overall suitability of the interviewee for a particular job or role. Interviews are commonly used in various fields, including job recruitment, academic admissions, and journalism.

TYPES OF INTERVIEW

There are several types of interviews, each serving different purposes. Here are some common types:

- **Structured Interview:** In this type, the interviewer follows a predetermined set of questions in a specific order. The goal is to maintain consistency and ensure that each candidate is evaluated on the same criteria.
- **Unstructured Interview:** This type is more conversational, and the interviewer does not follow a specific set of questions. It allows for a more free-flowing discussion, often exploring the candidate's personality, thought processes, and communication skills.
- **Behavioral Interview:** This type focuses on past behavior as an indicator of future performance. Candidates are asked to provide specific examples from their past experiences to demonstrate their skills and abilities.
- **Panel Interview:** In a panel interview, a candidate is interviewed by a group of interviewers. This is common in organizational settings where multiple perspectives are valuable in the hiring decision.
- **Phone or Video Interview:** With advancements in technology, interviews can be conducted over the phone or through video conferencing. These are often used as initial screening interviews before in-person meetings.
- **Group Interview:** Multiple candidates are interviewed simultaneously, providing the interviewers with an opportunity to observe how candidates interact with each other.
- **Technical Interview:** Common in fields like information technology and engineering, a technical interview assesses the candidate's knowledge and problem-solving skills related to the specific technical requirements of the job.

The interview process typically follows these general steps:

- **Preparation:** The interviewer(s) reviews the candidate's resume, cover letter, and any other relevant documents. The candidate may also prepare by researching the company and understanding the job requirements.
- **Introduction:** The interview starts with introductions and a brief overview of the interview process.
- **Questions and Answers:** The interviewer(s) asks the candidate a series of questions, which may include behavioral, situational, and technical questions. The candidate responds, providing examples and elaborating on their experiences and qualifications.
- **Assessment:** The interviewer assesses the candidate's responses, skills, and overall fit for the position.

- **Candidate Questions:** The candidate is often given an opportunity to ask questions about the company, the role, or any other relevant topics.
- **Closing:** The interview concludes with a summary of the next steps and any additional information the candidate needs.
- **Follow-Up:** After the interview, there may be follow-up steps, such as reference checks or additional interviews, leading to a final decision on whether to extend a job offer.